

Terms of Service

Version 1.0 | Effective 13 May 2026

Terms of Service

Trade Grid (Pty) Ltd — User Agreement

These Terms of Service ("Terms") govern your access to and use of the Trade Grid platform, including our website, mobile application, and all associated services. By creating an account or using any part of our platform, you agree to be legally bound by these Terms.

Please read this document carefully before registering. If you do not agree with any part of these Terms, you must not access or use the Trade Grid platform.

These Terms constitute a legally binding agreement between you (the "User") and Trade Grid (Pty) Ltd, a company registered in the Republic of South Africa.

Document	Terms of Service
Version	1.0
Effective Date	13 May 2026
Issued By	Trade Grid (Pty) Ltd
Address	1437 Market Street, Johannesburg, South Africa 2094
Contact	legal@tradegrid.com +27 (83) 720-4520

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1 Definitions

In these Terms, the following definitions apply:

- **"Platform"** means the Trade Grid website, mobile application, and all related services.
- **"User" / "You"** means any individual or business entity that registers for or uses the Platform.
- **"Business Profile"** means the verified business listing created by a User on the Platform.
- **"Match"** means an AI-generated connection suggestion between two Users.
- **"Trade Grid" / "We" / "Us"** means Trade Grid (Pty) Ltd, 1437 Market Street, Johannesburg, South Africa 2094.
- **"Content"** means all text, data, documents, images, and other material submitted to the Platform.
- **"Verification"** means the process by which Trade Grid confirms the existence and registration of a business entity.

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Eligibility & Account Registration

To register for and use Trade Grid, you must:

- Be a duly registered legal business entity or sole proprietor in your country of operation.
- Be at least 18 years of age if registering as an individual.
- Provide accurate, current, and complete registration information including your business registration number, CIPC number (where applicable), and a valid business email address.
- Maintain the security of your account credentials and notify us immediately of any unauthorised access or suspected breach.
- Not create more than one account per legal business entity without prior written consent from Trade Grid.

Trade Grid reserves the right to reject, suspend, or terminate any account that does not meet these requirements or that we reasonably believe presents a fraud or compliance risk. We may request additional verification documents at any time.

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3 Platform Services

Trade Grid provides the following core services to registered Users:

- **Smart Matching:** AI-powered suggestions connecting importers and exporters based on industry, products, geography, and trading preferences.
- **Business Profiles:** Verified public-facing profiles showcasing your company details, certifications, trade licences, and capabilities.
- **Market Insights:** Access to real-time and aggregated trade data, commodity trends, pricing indices, and regional market overviews.
- **Messaging & Introductions:** Secure in-platform communication between matched businesses to initiate trade relationships.
- **Document Vault:** Encrypted storage of uploaded verification documents with controlled access.
- **Masha AI Assistant:** An AI-powered chatbot to assist with platform navigation, trade queries, and partner discovery.

We reserve the right to modify, suspend, or discontinue any feature of the Platform at any time. We will provide reasonable advance notice to active Users of any material changes to core functionality.

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4 User Obligations & Acceptable Use

You agree to use the Platform only for lawful purposes and in accordance with these Terms. The following conduct is strictly prohibited:

- Submitting false, misleading, or fraudulent business information or documentation.
- Impersonating any person, business, or entity, or misrepresenting your affiliation with any organisation.
- Using the Platform to facilitate illegal trade, sanctions-prohibited transactions, money laundering, or terrorist financing.
- Scraping, harvesting, or systematically extracting data from the Platform without prior written authorisation from Trade Grid.
- Uploading malicious code, viruses, ransomware, or any software designed to damage or interfere with the Platform or other Users.
- Using automated bots, crawlers, scripts, or tools to interact with the Platform without prior written consent.
- Harassing, threatening, defaming, or abusing other Users or Trade Grid staff.
- Attempting to gain unauthorised access to other User accounts, system infrastructure, or confidential data.

Violation of these obligations may result in immediate account suspension or termination without refund, and may be reported to relevant law enforcement or regulatory authorities.

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5 Verification & Trust

Trade Grid operates a multi-step business verification process designed to build trust between trading parties. Verification status is prominently displayed on Business Profiles. However, Users must note the following important limitations:

- Verification confirms the existence and basic registration of a business entity — it does not constitute an endorsement, creditworthiness assessment, financial audit, or guarantee of trading quality.
- Users remain solely and entirely responsible for conducting their own due diligence, credit checks, and risk assessments before entering into any trade agreement or financial commitment.
- Trade Grid may revoke verified status at any time if we discover that submitted documents were false, expired, or obtained fraudulently.
- Trade Grid does not act as a principal, agent, guarantor, or intermediary in any trade transaction facilitated through the Platform.

Important: Trade Grid is a matching and networking platform only. We do not verify the quality of goods or services, and we are not a party to any contract formed between Users. All trade agreements are entered into entirely at your own risk.

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Intellectual Property

All intellectual property rights in the Platform — including the Trade Grid name, logo, software code, algorithms, AI models, design system, and proprietary data compilations — are owned by or licensed to Trade Grid (Pty) Ltd. All rights are reserved.

You retain full ownership of Content you submit to the Platform. By submitting Content, you grant Trade Grid a non-exclusive, royalty-free, worldwide, sub-licensable licence to use, store, display, reproduce, and process that Content solely for the purpose of providing, improving, and promoting our services.

You may not copy, reproduce, distribute, reverse-engineer, decompile, or create derivative works of any Trade Grid intellectual property without prior written consent from our legal team.

Trade Grid respects intellectual property rights. If you believe any Content on the Platform infringes your rights, please contact us at legal@tradegrid.com with full details of your claim.

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Fees & Subscriptions

Trade Grid offers the following tiered subscription plans:

- **Starter (Free):** Basic matching, limited profile visibility, access to Masha AI, and standard market insights.
- **Professional (Paid Monthly):** Unlimited matches, advanced analytics dashboard, priority listing in search results, full market data access, and priority support.
- **Enterprise (Custom Pricing):** White-glove onboarding, dedicated account manager, API access, custom integrations, and SLA guarantees.

All fees are billed in South African Rand (ZAR) unless otherwise agreed in writing. Prices are subject to change with 30 days written notice. Annual subscriptions may receive discounted rates. Refunds are issued at our discretion in accordance with applicable consumer protection legislation, including the Consumer Protection Act 68 of 2008.

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Limitation of Liability

To the maximum extent permitted by applicable law, Trade Grid and its directors, employees, agents, and partners shall not be liable for any:

- Indirect, incidental, special, consequential, or punitive damages.
- Loss of profits, revenue, business opportunities, goodwill, or data.
- Damages arising from your use of, or inability to use, the Platform.
- Damages arising from any trade transaction, agreement, or dispute between Users.
- Damages resulting from unauthorised access to your account or data.

Our total aggregate liability to you in respect of any single claim or series of related claims shall not exceed the subscription fees paid by you to Trade Grid in the three (3) calendar months immediately preceding the event giving rise to the claim.

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Dispute Resolution & Governing Law

These Terms are governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the Republic of South Africa, without regard to conflict of law principles.

In the event of any dispute, claim, or controversy arising out of or relating to these Terms or your use of the Platform, the parties agree to the following resolution process:

- **Step 1 — Negotiation:** The parties will attempt to resolve the dispute through good-faith negotiation within 30 days of written notice.
- **Step 2 — Mediation:** If unresolved after 30 days, the dispute will be referred to a mutually agreed mediator.
- **Step 3 — Arbitration:** If mediation fails, the dispute will be referred to binding arbitration under the rules of the Arbitration Foundation of Southern Africa (AFSA) before a single arbitrator in Johannesburg.

Nothing in this clause prevents either party from seeking urgent interim relief from a competent court where necessary to prevent irreparable harm.

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10 Changes to Terms & Contact Information

We may update these Terms from time to time to reflect changes in our services, applicable law, or business practices. We will notify you of material changes via:

- Email notification to the address registered on your account, and
- Prominent notice on the Platform, at least 14 days before the changes take effect.

Your continued use of the Platform after the effective date of updated Terms constitutes your acceptance of those changes. If you do not agree with the updated Terms, you must close your account before the changes take effect.

CONTACT US

For questions, concerns, or notices relating to these Terms of Service:

Email: legal@tradegrid.com

Post: Legal Department, Trade Grid (Pty) Ltd, 1437 Market Street, Johannesburg, South Africa 2094

Phone: +27 (83) 720-4520 | Hours: Monday–Friday, 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM SAST